

SquareUp — Participant Consent & AI Disclosure Script

Effective date: May 21, 2026

How to use this document. This script is an operational tool, not a contract. The consent and AI-disclosure language below must be delivered at the **start of every interview** — before any substantive questions and before recording the participant's responses. Use the version that matches how the interview begins. Adapt the wording to sound natural in the AI agent's voice, and translate it for non-English interviews, but do not drop any required element: AI disclosure, recording disclosure and consent, the voluntary nature of participation, the 18+ check, and where to find the full privacy notice.

Part A — Outbound call: opening script

Use this when SquareUp's AI agent places the call to the participant.

"Hi, this is an automated research assistant calling on behalf of [Research Organisation or SquareUp]. Before we go further, a few quick things.

First — I'm an **AI voice assistant**, not a human.

I'd like to ask you a few questions for a research study. It should take about [X] minutes, and **taking part is completely voluntary** — you can skip any question or stop at any time.

The conversation will be **recorded and transcribed** so your answers can be analysed for the study, and your responses may be shared with the organisation that commissioned the research.

This study is for **adults aged 18 or older**. Can you confirm you're 18 or older, and that it's okay to record this conversation and for you to take part?"

[Proceed only if the participant confirms they are 18+ and consents to recording and participation. If they decline, thank them and end the call without recording responses. If they ask not to be contacted again, log that request.]

Part B — Inbound / participant-initiated: opening script

Use this when the participant starts the interview themselves by dialling in or clicking a link.

"Hi, and thanks for joining this research interview for [Research Organisation or SquareUp]. A few quick things before we start.

I'm an **AI voice assistant**, not a human.

This should take about [X] minutes. **Taking part is voluntary** — you can skip any question or stop at any time.

The interview will be **recorded and transcribed** so your answers can be analysed, and your responses may be shared with the organisation that commissioned the research.

This study is for **adults 18 and older**. To continue, please confirm you're 18 or older and that you consent to being recorded and taking part."

[Proceed only on confirmation. A participant who joined via a web link should also have seen and accepted the written consent in Part C.]

Part C — Written / on-screen consent (web-based interviews)

Where a participant joins through a web page, show this consent text on screen and require an affirmative action — for example, ticking a box or clicking "I agree" — before the interview begins.

Before you begin this research interview, please read and agree to the following:

You will be interviewed by an **AI voice assistant**, not a human.

Your interview will be **recorded (audio) and transcribed** so your responses can be analysed for the research study.

Your responses may be **shared with the organisation that commissioned the research**.

Participation is voluntary. You may skip any question or stop at any time.

This study is for **adults aged 18 and over**.

SquareUp handles your information as described in the **Participant Privacy Notice** at joinsquareup.com/participant-privacy.

By continuing, I confirm I am 18 or older, and I consent to being recorded and to taking part in this interview.

Part D — Participant controls during the interview

The AI agent should recognise and honour these at any time, and the script should make them easy to use:

- **Skip** — "You can skip that one — just say 'skip' or 'next'."
- **Pause / stop** — if the participant asks to stop, the AI agent confirms: "No problem — we'll stop here. Nothing more will be recorded. Thank you for your time."
- **Withdraw** — if the participant asks to withdraw their data, the AI agent acknowledges: "I've noted that you'd like to withdraw. You can also email hello@joinsquareup.com to have your interview deleted."
- **Questions about privacy** — "You can find how your information is used in our Participant Privacy Notice, or email hello@joinsquareup.com."

Part E — Closing

"That's everything — thank you for taking part. Your responses will help **[Research Organisation or SquareUp]** with this research. If you have any questions about how your information is used, you can email hello@joinsquareup.com. Have a great day."

Part F — Implementation notes (for SquareUp's team — not read aloud)

- **Capture the consent.** The participant's confirmation of age, recording, and participation must itself be recorded or logged with a timestamp, so SquareUp can evidence consent. Begin substantive recording only after consent is given.
- **All-party consent states.** Several U.S. states require all parties to a call to consent to its recording. Treat affirmative recording consent as mandatory for every interview, regardless of state, so the same flow is compliant everywhere.
- **Outbound calling and the TCPA.** Outbound calls using an AI / artificial voice require the called party's prior express consent. For SquareUp-sourced participants, obtain that consent before calling; for client-supplied contacts, the client warrants it under the MSA and AUP. Honour do-not-call and opt-out requests immediately, maintain an internal do-not-call list, and observe permitted calling hours.
- **AI-disclosure laws.** The AI-disclosure line is required by a growing set of laws (for example, in Utah, California, and Colorado). Keep it at the very start of the interview and never omit it.
- **Automated screening.** The AI may decide a participant's study eligibility automatically from screening answers. This is disclosed in the Participant Privacy Notice; make sure participants can reach a person (the privacy inbox) with any question about a screening outcome.
- **Translations.** When interviewing in another language, use a faithful translation of this script that preserves every required element.
- **No interviews with minors.** If a participant indicates they are under 18, end the interview immediately and do not retain their responses.
- **Withdrawals.** Route withdrawal requests to the privacy inbox and delete the relevant interview data, coordinating with the Research Organisation where it is the controller.